1. Eligibility and weekly schedule

1.1 This policy applies to regular employees of Aster Vale Works Pvt. Ltd. whose duties can be performed securely away from an office. An employee becomes eligible after 90 calendar days of continuous service. Agency workers, consultants and trainees follow their signed engagement terms. Eligibility permits a request; it does not guarantee a remote day or change the employee's role, hours or place of employment.

1.2 The standard allowance is up to three remote workdays in a Monday-to-Friday workweek. The employee and manager agree fixed office anchor days for team training, equipment access and shared work. Weekly schedules should be entered in the team calendar by Thursday for the following week. A public holiday or approved leave day is not converted into a replacement remote day.

1.3 An employee may request a temporary fourth remote day for a specific week. The department head must approve it in writing before the week begins; the standard maximum remains four days. A fifth remote day is not allowed under this policy. A manager may ask for an office day when a defined duty requires physical attendance, with as much notice as reasonably practical.

1.4 New employees within their first 90 days work at the assigned office unless the department head approves a short-term exception for a documented access need. The exception must state dates, location and supervision arrangements and cannot extend beyond 30 calendar days without People Operations review.

1.5 Remote work may be performed only from the employee's approved home or another private location within India. Working from another country is prohibited without prior written approval from People Operations and the department head, plus any required immigration, tax and security review. Personal travel does not itself authorize remote work from the destination.

2. Request, approval and availability

2.1 Submit a recurring schedule or a one-time location change to the manager at least two working days in advance. Include the requested dates, work location, normal hours and any planned coverage change. The manager should reply within one working day. The request is not approved until the manager updates the calendar or sends written confirmation.

2.2 Managers approve up to three remote days per week when service coverage, training and access needs are met. The department head approves a fourth day for a named week. Managers may temporarily require office attendance for a client session, secure equipment task or planned team workshop; they should give two working days' notice when known in advance and explain the work need.

2.3 Remote employees keep their agreed working hours and remain reachable through the usual team channel during those hours. A meal break is recorded in the calendar if it differs from the normal team schedule. The employee should acknowledge a time-sensitive message within 30 minutes when not in a meeting or break, or set a status with a return time. This is an availability rule, not a requirement to monitor messages outside scheduled hours.

2.4 Attend scheduled meetings with working audio and a private setting. If the connection fails, call in by the approved method or notify the organizer within 10 minutes. For a planned appointment or interruption longer than one hour, tell the manager and update the calendar; use leave if the employee will not work the scheduled hours.

2.5 The manager reviews the arrangement every quarter with the employee. Review points are delivery, team coverage, equipment and any location change. A change should be discussed before the next schedule is published. If approval is declined or withdrawn, the manager records the business reason and effective date, normally at least five working days ahead except for an urgent safety or security concern.

3. Workspace, equipment and information

3.1 Work from a stable surface with enough privacy to prevent others from seeing screens or hearing confidential calls. Use a headset in shared spaces. Do not work from a public computer, an open public Wi-Fi network or a location where another person can view company material. If privacy cannot be maintained, pause the task and tell the manager.

3.2 Use only a company-issued or service-desk-approved device. Keep operating system updates enabled, use multi-factor authentication and lock the screen whenever leaving the workspace. Store files in the approved company workspace; do not forward work documents to a personal email, personal cloud drive or removable device. Paper notes containing work information must be kept out of view and securely destroyed when no longer needed.

3.3 A household member or visitor may not use a company device or account. Do not discuss sensitive work in a shared room or on speakerphone. Before a video call, check the visible background for documents, badges and personal information. Recording or transcription requires the same approval as an office meeting and notice to all participants.

3.4 The company supplies the standard laptop and required security tools. A monitor, keyboard or other accessory requires manager approval up to INR 15,000 per item under the Expenses Policy. Higher cost approval follows that policy before purchase. Routine home internet and electricity are personal costs and are not reimbursed unless the department head and Finance Desk approve a written exception in advance.

3.5 Report a lost device, suspected account compromise or accidental disclosure to servicedesk@astervaleworks.example immediately, and no later than one hour after discovery when feasible. Preserve relevant details and follow service desk instructions. Do not investigate by accessing another person's account or delete evidence. The service desk coordinates containment and tells the employee when normal work can resume.

4. Safety, expenses and exceptions

4.1 The employee is responsible for a safe home work area, including clear walkways, a suitable chair and reasonable screen height. Report a work-related injury to the manager and People Support Desk on the same working day. The company may arrange a confidential safety review with reasonable notice; the review is limited to the designated work area and does not authorize general access to the home.

4.2 A remote arrangement does not change leave, attendance or expense rules. If illness prevents work, notify the manager and record leave under the Leave Policy. If a manager requests travel to an office or work site, get the travel plan approved before booking and submit eligible costs under the Expenses Policy. A normal commute to an assigned office is not a reimbursable expense.

4.3 An employee who moves home or plans to work regularly from a different address must notify the manager and People Operations at least five working days before the change. Provide the new city and effective date through the private People Support Desk channel; do not place a full home address in a team calendar. People Operations confirms whether the location remains inside the permitted work region.

4.4 A temporary exception to the three-day schedule requires the department head's written approval. A location outside India or an exception involving restricted information also requires People Operations and security review before work begins. No manager can waive device, confidentiality or legal requirements. An exception record names the employee, dates, safeguards and approvers.

4.5 Questions about eligibility, schedule or a work-related injury go to people@astervaleworks.example. For device access, connectivity or suspected disclosure, contact servicedesk@astervaleworks.example. The employee should continue the approved office schedule while a request is under review. People Operations reviews this policy each January and records any revision date on the current controlled copy.